

Sailor Bow

HAIR-CLIP FINISH · LOOPS UP, MITRED TAILS HANGING APART

THE NUMBERS COME FROM [designs/sailor-bow-pattern.dc.html](https://www.dragoninkandthread.com/designs/sailor-bow-pattern.dc.html) — six pages, with the pieces printable at actual size. This is the one-page workroom version.  Two documents, one set of numbers: change them together.

6" × 6"	1/4"	2"	I
FINISHED	SEAM · INCLUDED IN THE CUTS	ALLIGATOR CLIP	FAT QUARTER PER BOW

Cut list

SEAM ALLOWANCE ALREADY IN THESE — DO NOT ADD IT

PIECE	CUT	NOTES
A · Loop	12" × 6"	1 on the fold. Grainline runs along the 12". Optional lightweight fusible interfacing here if the cotton is limp.
B · Tails	11" × 7"	1 on the fold, with the POINTED ends — the diagonal. Grainline along the 11".
C · Centre wrap	4" × 1½"	Single layer. Finishes about ¾" wide.
D · Clip cover	3" × 1"	Optional. Single layer. Hides the metal.

Sewing it

TEN STEPS

1. **Cut.** A and B on the fold, C and D single. Press flat.
2. **Loop tube.** Fold A lengthwise right sides together to 12" × 3", sew the long raw edge, both short ends open. Turn.
3. **Press the seam to the back** — roll the tube so the seam centres on one face. **Press hard.** Finished tube 12" × 2¾".
4. **Form the loops.** Fold both short ends to the middle of the back, raw ends butted, and zigzag across the join. About 6" wide. Pinch the centre into two or three folds and wind thread tight.
5. **Tails.** Fold B lengthwise to 11" × 3½". Sew the long edge and **both diagonal ends**, leaving the 2" gap at the centre. **Trim the points close**, turn, poke them sharp, press, slip-stitch the gap.
6. **Gather the tails.** Three or four accordion pleats across the middle until it measures about 1½". Wind thread tight.
7. **Centre wrap.** Press C's long edges to the middle, fold again, press.
8. **Join.** Loop unit on top of the pleated tails, backs together. Wrap C once round both and hand-stitch at the back.
9. **Clip.** Fold D the same way, wrap the top blade, glue. Then glue or stitch the clip to the back of the wrap, **opening downward**.
10. **Shape.** Steam the loops open into rounded ears; press the tails so the points hang straight and slightly apart.

Batch

YOU SEW THESE FIFTEEN AT A TIME

Safe planning figure: one fat quarter = one bow, which is what the pattern says and what to buy against.

 **CALCULATED, NOT MEASURED: about 8 bows per yard** of 44" cotton, cutting both A and B from the same yard with the grain along the length. **Count the next batch and tell me the real number** and I will write it in — a fat quarter each is generous and yardage does much better.

 **THE CLIP IS THE SUPPLY THAT RUNS OUT.** One 2" alligator clip per bow, and there are around **34 bows in stock**. Fabric you always have; clips you have to have bought. **Count them when you count bows.**

Watch for

The mitred points are the whole job. Trim close to the stitching before turning, and poke them properly sharp. A rounded point is what makes a bow look homemade.

Press after every seam. Cotton takes a hard press and crisp loops depend on it.

Keep the wrap tight. C is not decoration — it is what holds the bow's shape.

Leave the 2" gap in B. It ends up hidden under the wrap.

A tossed or all-over print looks best — the tails hang at an angle, so a print with a clear top and bottom fights you.

\$12 each, or 2 for \$20. Bow names come from the fabric library, so a bow and its swatch share a name.  **No custom band on this sheet** — the bands live in eight places and all eight change together.